

REQUEST FOR EMPANELMENT

Empanelment of Valuation Agencies / Experts

For startup valuation, pricing support, instrument structuring inputs, and related transaction support for RTIH and its ecosystem

Issuing Entity	Ratan Tata Innovation Hub Amaravati Foundation (RTIH)
Document Ref No	RTIH-AMVT/RFE/2026/003
Issue Date	21 Apr 2026
Submission Mode	Single Google Form response with structured uploads
Application Window	Open on a rolling basis
Review Cycle	Applications will ordinarily be reviewed once every quarter

Empanelment Type

Non-exclusive; no work order guarantee

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1. Background and Purpose

Ratan Tata Innovation Hub Amaravati Foundation (RTIH) invites applications from eligible valuation firms, registered valuers, advisory LLPs / companies, and other legally eligible professional entities for empanelment on a non-exclusive basis to provide startup valuation and related pricing support for RTIH and its ecosystem.

This RFE is issued solely for identification and empanelment purposes and does not constitute an offer, contract, or commitment of any nature.

Applicants shall participate at their own cost and RTIH shall have no liability whatsoever for any costs incurred.

The empanelled panel is intended to support structured startup funding, scheme-linked evaluation, investment readiness, pricing of equity / quasi-equity / debt-linked support, and other transaction or committee processes where independent valuation inputs are considered necessary or useful.

2. Rolling Application & Review Cycle

Milestone	Date
Release of RFE	21 Apr 2026
Application Mode	Rolling / open call
Submission Channel	RTIH Google Form with structured uploads
Review Frequency	Ordinarily once a quarter
Review Cut-Off	RTIH may adopt quarterly cut-off dates for administrative convenience and may notify the current applicable cut-off on the website / Google Form / related communication
Clarifications	May be submitted on a rolling basis to proposals@rtih.co.in
Communication of Empanelment	After each review cycle or as otherwise determined
Applications received after a review cut-off	May be considered in the next review cycle

3. Nature of Empanelment

- The empanelment is non-exclusive.
- RTIH may empanel one or more firms / experts.
- Assignments may be issued from time to time based on requirement, specialization, responsiveness, commercial reasonableness, sector fit, independence, timelines, and past performance.
- Empanelment shall not guarantee any minimum number of assignments, minimum fee, or preferred status.
- Quoted rates will serve as pre-agreed reference rates unless RTIH separately seeks confirmation for a specific transaction or materially non-standard requirement.
- RTIH reserves the absolute right, at its sole discretion, to allocate, withhold, or discontinue assignments without assigning reasons, provided such action is taken in good faith.

4. Indicative Scope of Services

- Valuation of early-stage, pre-revenue, revenue-stage, and growth-stage startups.
- Preparation of valuation reports / certificates / pricing notes for funding, grant-plus, investment support, co-investment readiness, or other RTIH-approved purposes.
- Cap table review, dilution analysis, ESOP pool consideration, and scenario modelling where relevant.
- Pricing support for equity, compulsorily convertible instruments, convertible debentures, debt-linked instruments, SAFE-like structures, revenue-linked instruments, or other permitted structures.
- Review of assumptions, comparable benchmarks, valuation methodology, and reasonableness of founder / investor expectations.
- Committee or board presentation support, clarification notes, and revised reports where facts change materially before closure.
- Urgent or short-turnaround assignments, if specifically requested by RTIH.

5. Eligibility Criteria

- Applicant should be a registered valuer, valuation / transaction advisory firm, CA firm, LLP, company, or other legally valid professional services entity with authority to render the proposed services.

- Minimum 3 years of relevant experience is required.
- Demonstrable experience in startup / venture / emerging-company valuation is strongly preferred.
- Experience in technology, innovation, manufacturing, deeptech, social impact, MSME, or similar early-stage ecosystems will be viewed favourably.
- Applicant should be capable of issuing GST invoice where applicable.
- Applicant should not be blacklisted by any government department, PSU, statutory body, or court order at the time of submission.
- Applicant must be willing to comply with RTIH's conflict of interest, confidentiality, and data handling requirements.

6. Information to be Submitted

- Firm profile, legal constitution, office locations, SPOC details, and service coverage.
- Profile of key valuation professionals and relevant registration / membership details.
- Summary of relevant assignments, preferably including startup, venture, or transaction pricing engagements.
- Typical monthly capacity and average turnaround times for standard and urgent assignments.
- Approach note on valuation methodology, quality review, conflict checks, and assignment escalation.
- Indicative sectors of strength and any exclusions / limitations in service coverage.

7. Submission Structure and Method

Applications shall be submitted through the RTIH Google Form link published on the website. The form and uploads should be structured as follows:

- **Part A – Technical / Capability Submission:** firm profile, registrations, key personnel, relevant experience, sector coverage, methodology note, turnaround time, conflict-management approach, and relevant uploads.
- **Part B – Commercial Submission:** signed rate card for the minimum service basket, taxes / statutory charges treatment, and any optional or special-case services.

RTIH may review technical suitability first and may compare commercial submissions among firms considered suitable for empanelment. This separation

is for screening convenience and does not require a formal two-envelope tender process.

All uploaded files should clearly identify the applicant firm and document type in the filename (for example: FirmName_TechnicalProfile.pdf, FirmName_CommercialRateCard.pdf, FirmName_Declaration.pdf).

Commercial Schedule

S No	Service Item	Unit for Quote	Quote Required
C1	Startup valuation - pre-revenue / prototype / early validation stage	Per startup	Mandatory
C2	Startup valuation - revenue stage / traction stage	Per startup	Mandatory
C3	Event-triggered revaluation / valuation update (including annual validation, exit, buyback, follow-on round, restructuring, or write-off review)	Per startup	Mandatory
C4	Cap table, dilution, and scenario modelling note	Per assignment	Mandatory
C5	Instrument structuring / pricing note for convertible or debt-linked support	Per assignment	Mandatory
C6	Committee / board presentation or meeting support	Per meeting / assignment	Mandatory
C7	Urgent assignment surcharge, if any	Per assignment	Mandatory or enter 0
C8	Optional additional services proposed by bidder	Specify unit	Optional

Submission Checklist

Document / Input	Mandatory	Remarks
Part A – Firm profile and contact details	Yes	In Google Form / uploaded profile deck

Document / Input	Mandatory	Remarks
Part A – Registration proof and profile of key valuation professionals	Yes	Registration / membership details as applicable
Part A – Relevant experience note / client examples	Yes	Non-confidential examples are sufficient
Part A – Methodology and conflict-management note	Yes	1-3 pages recommended
Part A – Conflict of interest and no-blacklisting declaration	Yes	Signed on letterhead
Part B – Signed and stamped commercial rate card	Yes	Professional fee separate from taxes / expenses
Part B – Special-case pricing sheet, if any	No	Optional but recommended
Public listing consent and logo upload	No	Only if the bidder wants RTIH to showcase the firm publicly

8. Evaluation Approach

- Eligibility and completeness of submission.
- Depth and relevance of valuation experience, especially in startup or emerging-company contexts.
- Quality and seniority of the proposed team.
- Methodology, independence, conflict-management, and review safeguards.
- Turnaround commitments, responsiveness, and commercial reasonableness.

9. Optional Public Listing of Empanelled Firms

RTIH may choose to showcase consenting empanelled firms on its website, decks, or ecosystem materials for discoverability. Applicants may opt in separately for such listing.

- The bidder may provide firm logo, website / LinkedIn link, office locations, and a short public profile for such listing.

- Public display by RTIH shall be optional and subject to explicit bidder consent.
- Such listing shall not amount to endorsement, ranking, preferred partner status, exclusivity, or guarantee of work allocation.

10. Key Terms & General Provisions

Audit Rights

RTIH may audit relevant records with reasonable notice. Records to be retained for five (5) years.

Anti-Corruption

Firm shall comply with anti-bribery and anti-corruption laws.

Force Majeure

Neither party is liable for delays due to events beyond reasonable control.

Proposal Validity

All submissions made in response to this RFE shall remain valid and binding for a period of 90 days from the date of submission, unless a longer validity is expressly stated by the applicant.

Nature of Empanelment and No Work Guarantee

This RFE is being issued for the purpose of non-exclusive empanelment of suitable professional firms. Empanelment shall not create any exclusive right, preferred status, minimum business assurance, or guaranteed work allocation in favour of any empanelled firm.

Empanelment Period

Unless otherwise specified by RTIH, empanelment under this RFE shall remain valid for a period of two (2) years from the date of empanelment, unless extended, suspended, or terminated earlier by RTIH.

Work Allocation and Confirmation of Capacity

RTIH may allocate assignments individually or in batches. Before issuing any specific assignment, RTIH may seek confirmation of availability, independence, acceptance of timelines, and applicability of quoted rates.

Technical and Commercial Review

RTIH may assess technical suitability first and may compare commercial submissions among firms considered suitable for empanelment. RTIH is not bound to adopt a lowest-price-only approach.

Applications received after any administrative quarterly review cut-off may be taken up in the subsequent review cycle, without creating any right in favour of the applicant for consideration in a particular cycle.

Confidentiality

Applicants and empanelled firms shall treat all non-public information, documents, startup data, financial information, and transaction materials shared by RTIH in connection with this RFE or any assignment as confidential and shall not disclose or use the same except for the relevant engagement.

- Information shall be used strictly for the purpose of the assignment
- No reuse, benchmarking, or indirect use permitted
- Obligation shall survive for five (5) years
- Firm shall implement reasonable data security safeguards

RTIH shall be entitled to injunctive relief in case of breach.

Conflict of Interest

Applicants must disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest, including any personal, professional, financial, advisory, investor, or founder relationship that may impair, or appear to impair, their independence or objectivity in relation to RTIH or any startup / transaction under review.

- Firm shall NOT undertake assignment where conflict exists
- RTIH may require recusal or replace firm
- Mandatory independence confirmation per assignment

Compliance with Applicable Law and Professional Standards

Each applicant shall be solely responsible for ensuring that its participation and any services proposed or rendered pursuant to this RFE are fully compliant with all applicable laws, regulations, valuation standards, and professional conduct requirements.

Accuracy of Information / Misrepresentation

If at any stage an applicant is found to have misrepresented facts, concealed material information, submitted false documents, or otherwise acted in a fraudulent, corrupt, or unfair manner, RTIH may reject the application, cancel empanelment, withdraw any work allocation, or take such other action as it deems appropriate, without liability.

Data Protection

The firm shall comply with all applicable data protection laws including the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023.

- No unauthorized data transfer (especially cross-border)
- Data breach to be reported within 48 hours
- Processing limited to assignment purpose only

Indemnity

The empanelled firm shall indemnify, defend, and hold harmless RTIH, its officers, employees, and partner institutions from and against losses, claims, damages, penalties, costs, or expenses arising out of professional negligence, breach of confidentiality, third-party claims, regulatory penalties, losses arising directly or indirectly from services, non-compliance with applicable law, or misconduct by the firm or its personnel.

THIS OBLIGATION SHALL SURVIVE TERMINATION.

Information Disclaimer

RTIH does not guarantee completeness or accuracy of information provided.

The firm shall independently verify all inputs.

Insurance

The firm shall maintain professional indemnity insurance and provide proof upon request.



Governing Law and Jurisdiction

This RFE and any empanelment arising from it shall be governed by and construed in accordance with the laws of India. Courts at Amaravati, Andhra Pradesh shall have exclusive jurisdiction.

Non-Binding Nature of RFE

No binding relationship, contractual obligation, or enforceable rights shall arise from this RFE or empanelment unless and until a separate written work order or engagement letter is issued by RTIH.

Subcontracting

No subcontracting without RTIH approval.

Termination

RTIH may:

- terminate empanelment for convenience
- terminate immediately for breach, conflict, or misconduct

Annexure 1: Minimum Scope Inclusions for Mandatory Commercial Items

For purposes of commercial comparison, the quoted professional fees for the mandatory commercial items under the Commercial Schedule shall, at a minimum, include the activities listed below. Unless expressly stated otherwise, quoted professional fees under this Annexure shall not include taxes, travel, or other third-party out-of-pocket expenses.

C1. Startup valuation - pre-revenue / prototype / early validation stage must include:

- review of the startup's basic documents, cap table, business summary, and information pack made available for the assignment
- selection and application of an appropriate valuation approach suited to a very early-stage company
- preparation of a draft valuation note or report with assumptions, methodology, and key drivers
- one round of routine clarification / revision based on comments received from RTIH
- final report / note / certificate, as applicable

C2. Startup valuation - revenue stage / traction stage must include:

- review of basic financial information, commercial traction, and transaction context
- valuation using appropriate methodology with explicit assumptions and benchmarks
- preparation of draft and final deliverables with one round of routine revision

C3. Event-triggered revaluation / valuation update (including annual validation, exit, buyback, follow-on round, restructuring, or write-off review) must include:

- review of changes in facts or assumptions since the previous deliverable
- updated valuation note / certificate, with summary of revisions

C4. Cap table, dilution, and scenario modelling note must include:

- review of shareholding, convertibles, ESOP pool, or other basic instruments shared for the assignment

- scenario-based dilution / pricing analysis, to the extent relevant and requested

C5. Instrument structuring / pricing note for convertible or debt-linked support must include:

- review of proposed structure and basic terms shared by RTIH
- pricing / conversion range note or comparable rationale, to the extent relevant

C6. Committee / board presentation or meeting support must include:

- participation in one internal presentation / clarification meeting related to the assignment
- response to routine questions on methodology, assumptions, and outputs

Annexure 2: Indicative Document Responsibility Matrix

- Startup / relevant entity: provides incorporation / statutory documents, cap table, financial and commercial information, pitch materials, and other supporting information required for the relevant assignment.
- Empanelled firm: reviews completeness of information, identifies gaps, undertakes the valuation or pricing analysis within scope, prepares the deliverable set, and provides status updates and clarifications.
- RTIH: facilitates coordination, shares transaction context and required scope, monitors status for RTIH-routed matters, and supports escalation where required.